EPFO Newsletter

January - March 2025

(Edition-4)

Nari Shakti Se Viksit Bharat

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Organisation Initiatives during January-March 2025

1. Rollout of CPPS

The Union Minister of Labour and Employment and Chairperson of the Central Board of Trustees, EPF has approved the proposal for a Centralized Pension Payment System (CPPS) for Employees' Pension Scheme, 1995.

In the month of February 2025, about ₹1612 crore was disbursed to more than 69 lakh pensioners.

In the month of March 2025, a pension amount of Rs. ₹1656 crore was disbursed through 68 lakh transactions (approx.) under CPPS.

A specialized cell named the Centralized Pension Payment and Reconciliation Centre (CPPRC) has been set up at regional office Delhi West (Dwarka) to manage the operations and to ensure smooth functioning of CPPS.

2. Recent IT Developments:

During this quarter, several initiatives aimed at enabling ease of living for EPFO members were implemented on EPFO IT Systems. These include:

- **Simplified Joint Declaration Facility:**

A simplified Joint declaration facility with change/correction of member profile was introduced; the corrections can be self-approved by the member subject to certain validations. Due to which only 5 to 10% of the total cases would require the request to be sent at the EPFO level for acceptance.

- **Online Transfer Claims without Employer Approval:**

EPF members with fully compliant e-KYC EPF accounts can now file their Online Transfer Claims directly with EPFO without requiring approval of their employer. During FY 2024-25 more than 90% claims (78 lakhs) of the total claims filed instantly reached EPFO. If any member has already filed his transfer claim which is pending with the employer, the member can delete the already filed request and submit claim directly with EPFO.

- **Delinking of Erroneous / Fraudulent UAN Linkages:**

A Facility has now been provided to members in their UAN login to delink erroneous / fraudulent linkage of their UAN to deter unscrupulous activities.

- **Faster Processing of Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW) Cases:**

In order to expedite and smoothen the processing of PoHW cases, the 3-level approval for uploading rejection cases

on the pension portal has been reduced to a single level (at DA level only).

- **Auto claim processing**

As part of on-going initiatives to enhance auto-claim processing, the monetary limit was initially increased from ₹ 50,000 to ₹ 1, 00,000, enabling a broader range of claims to be handled automatically. In addition to illness, new categories such as housing, marriage and education were incorporated in auto-claim processing, significantly expanding the scope of eligible claims. Continuous improvements in validation processes throughout the year have supported a higher volume of claims being processed in auto-mode. As a result, auto-claims are now being settled within three days of receipt.

- **Simplification of claim processing**

To simplify claim processing, several key initiatives have been undertaken. The dependency on employers for PF account transfers during job changes has been significantly reduced, allowing EPFO to process transfer claims directly and thereby improving turnaround times.

Members are no longer required to upload images of cheque leaves or attested bank passbooks for online claims. This move has already benefited approximately 1.7 crore members in FY 2024–25.

Bank account verification is now carried out electronically through Banks or NPCI, minimizing claim rejections and grievances arising from poor-quality or unreadable uploads and the need for employer verification of bank account details has been removed, resulting in smoother application processes and quicker settlements.

UAN allotment and activation have also been simplified through the introduction of biometric authentication, ensuring authenticity, reducing the risk of fraud and streamlining member registration.

3. EPFO Payroll Data

The provisional payroll data of EPFO released on 22nd January 2025 highlights that EPFO has added 14.63 lakh net subscribers during the month of November, 2024. The year-on-year analysis shows a growth of 4.88% in net member additions compared to November, 2023.

The provisional payroll data of EPFO released on 25th February 2025 highlights that EPFO has added 16.05 lakh net subscribers during the month of December, 2024. The year-on-year analysis shows a growth of 2.74% in net member additions compared to December, 2023.

The provisional payroll data of EPFO released on 20th March2025 highlights that EPFO has added 17.89 lakh net Subscribers during the month of January, 2025. The year-on-year analysis shows a growth of 11.67% in net member additions compared to January, 2024.

Activities held during January-March 2025

1. Meetings held in January-March 2025

a. 111th meeting of the Executive Committee

The 111th meeting of the Executive Committee of the Central Board of Trustees, EPF, was chaired by Ms. Sumita Dawra, Secretary (Ministry of Labour and Employment), on 18 January,2025 several important agenda items were discussed.

The agenda items included the admissibility of Fixed Medical Allowance to spouses of staff pensioners, approval for redistribution of Commissioner Cadre posts, implementation of CITES 2.01, status of pension on higher wages, proposal for an Alternative Dispute Resolution mechanism, and review of grievance redressal mechanisms.

Ms. Sumita Dawra ,Secretary MoLE during the meeting

111th Meeting of Executive Committee

b. 112th Meeting of Executive Committee, CBT (EPF)

The 112th Executive Committee meeting of CBT (EPF) was held on February 25, 2025, at EPFO Headquarters, New Delhi, chaired by Smt. Sumita Dawra, Secretary (Ministry of Labour & Employment).

The agenda discussed in the meeting included the adoption of the Unified Pension Scheme for EPFO employees ,a status report on delegation of administrative/financial powers, an update on the Centralized Pension Payments System, a review of the Supreme Court judgement on higher wages pensions, progress on CITES 2.01 implementation, and court case disposal with respect to EPFO.

Ms. Sumita Dawra , Secretary of Ministry of Labour and Employment and CPFC of EPFO during the meeting

During the meeting, important agenda items such as recommending interest rates for EPF members, enhancing EDLI benefits, reviewing revised EPFO estimates, proposing surrender /cancellation of exemptions under section 17(4) of Employees Provident Fund and Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952, extending probationary periods for six officers, information on EPFO transfer policies, status updates on the Centralized Pension Payments System, and Supreme Court judgement on higher wages were discussed.

112th Meeting of Executive Committee, CBT (EPF)

Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya during the 237th CBT Meeting

c. 237th Meeting of Central Board of Trustees (CBT), EPF The 237th Meeting of the Central Board of Trustees (CBT), EPF was held on February 28, 2025 at EPFO Headquarters, New Delhi,under the Chairmanship of Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, Hon'ble Union Minister for Labour & Employment, Vice-Chairpersonship of Smt. Sushri Shobha Karandlaje, Hon'ble Minister of State for Labour & Employment & Co-Vice-Chairmanship of Smt. Sumita Dawra, Secretary (Ministry of Labour & Employment).

237th CBT Meeting at EPFO Head Office

d. 113th Meeting of Executive Committee, CBT (EPF)

113th meeting of Executive Committee, CBT (EPF) was held on March 28, 2025 at Srinagar, Jammu & Kashmir under the chairpersonship of Smt. Sumita Dawra, Secretary (Labour & Employment). During the meeting, the details on inoperative accounts in EPFO,the status report on the "Simplification of Settlement of Claims", the status note on Hon'ble Supreme Court Judgment dated 04.11.2022 regarding Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW) and progress in the implementation of CITES 2.01 were discussed.

2. Interaction Programme of Hon'ble Union Minister of Labour & Employment with APFCs 2024 batch

On February 25, 2025, Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya, the Union Minister for Labour & Employment and Youth Affairs & Sports, addressed a group of 145 newly inducted Assistant PF Commissioners (APFCs) of the Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi. The event featured the presence of Sushri Shobha Karandlaje, the Union Minister of State for Labour & Employment and Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises, as well as Shri Ramesh Krishnamurthi, the Central Provident Fund Commissioner of the EPFO. During this occasion, the Hon'ble Minister also unveiled a new logo for the Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya National Academy of Social Security (PDUNASS).

Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya during the Interaction Programme

Newly inducted Assistant PF Commissioners (APFCs) of EPFO

3. Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0

Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0 is a monthly District Outreach Program of EPFO commenced in January 2023.Under this program, District Camps are organized on the 27th of every month or the next working day in case 27th is a holiday to provide various on-the-spot services to members, such as e-nomination filing, KYC seeding, and claim-related services.

Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0 Camps organised during January – March 2025:

MONTH/YEAR	NO. OF DISTRICTS CAMPS COVERED	TOTAL ATTENDEES	TOTAL NO. OF GRIEVANCES RECEIVED	TOTAL NO. OF GRIEVANCES REDRESSED/ RESOLVED ON THE SPOT
JANUARY 2025	648	17,041	6,886	6,317
FEBRUARY 2025	641	16,746	6,737	6,175
MARCH 2025	635	16,705	6,751	6,074

Regional Office Salem

Regional Office Guntur

Regional Office Howrah

Regional Office Allahabad

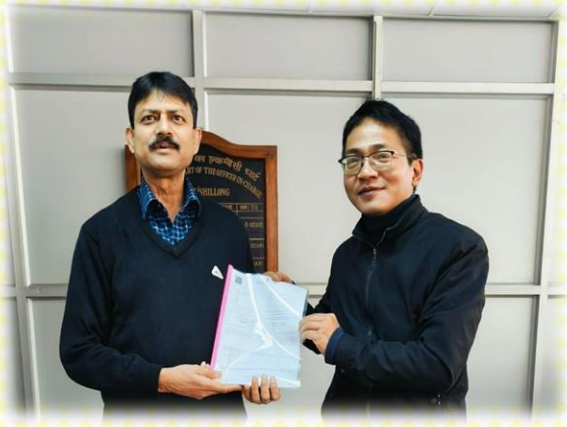
4.Prayaas – PPO on the day of Retirement

EPFO ensures pension disbursement under EPS, 1995, which include vulnerable sections like senior citizens, women, children and orphans. Under the 'Prayaas' initiative, field offices of EPFO are handing over PPOs to members of EPS 1995 on the day of their superannuation.
The number of PPO's issued during this quarter:

January 2025 : 1776 PPOs

February 2025 : 870 PPOs

March 2025 : 1302 PPOs



Regional Office Shillong

Regional Office Chennai (North)

Regional Office Ludhiana

5. Republic Day Celebration

Republic Day marks the adoption of India's constitution and the country's transition to a republic on 26 January, 1950. This day was celebrated in EPFO zonal and regional offices with great enthusiasm and patriotic spirit with tricolor themed decorations and flag-hoisting ceremonies.

DID YOU KNOW?

During the closing ceremony event at PDUNASS on 16.01.2025 , three E-Booklets on “Delicious Initiatives”, “Book Review” and “Outbound Training” were launched by CPFC of EPFO.

Regional Office Rajkot

Regional Office Dehradun

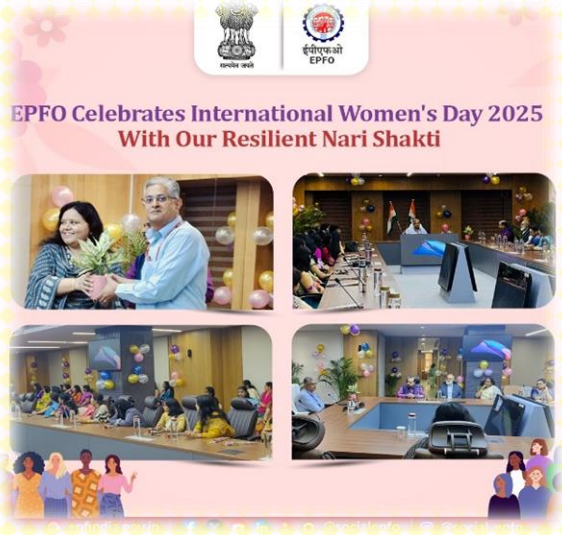
Regional Office Durgapur

Regional Office Bareilly

6. Women's Day Celebration

International Women's Day is celebrated around the world on 8th March. It is a day when women are recognized for their achievements across national, ethnic, linguistic, cultural, economic or political boundaries.

The theme of International Women's Day 2025 is **"For ALL Women and Girls:Rights.Equality.Empowerment "** This year's theme calls for action to unlock equal rights, power and opportunities for all and an inclusive future where no one is left behind. This day was celebrated in EPFO offices across the country.



EPFO Head Office

Did You Know

Under Nidhi Aapke Nikat 2.0 program, District camps are organized on the 27th of every month or the next working day in case 27th is a holiday.

Regional Office Barkatpura

Regional Office Ludhiana

Regional Office Thane (South)

7. Physical Infrastructure Developments in EPFO

a) Inauguration of New Office Building at Begumpet on 06.03.2025 .

Hon'ble Union Minister for Labour & Employment and Youth Affairs & Sports inaugurated the New Office Complex of the Zonal Office Telangana, Regional Office (RO) Banjara Hills and Alternate Data Centre (ADC) at Begumpet, Hyderabad on 06.03.2025. Hon'ble Union Minister for Coal and Mines, Sri G. Kishan Reddy, Sri M Raghunadan Rao, Hon'ble Member of Parliament, Medak, Sri Ramesh Krishnamurthy, Central Provident Fund Commissioner (CPFC) and Senior officers from the Ministry and Employees' Provident Fund Organization and other distinguished guests were present on the occasion.

Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya inaugurating New Office Building at Begumpet

During the inauguration ceremony

b) Virtual inauguration of newly constructed office building at Naroda, Gujarat by Hon'ble Minister for Labour & Employment and Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports was done on 06.03.2025.

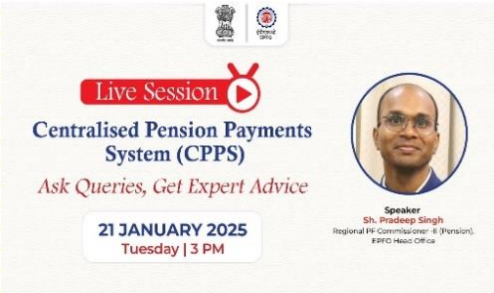
c) Virtual Bhoomi Pujan of land at Sector-9, Gurugram was done by Hon'ble Minister Labour & Employment and Minister of Youth Affairs and Sports on 06.03.2025.

8. Live Sessions on Social Media Platforms

EPFO conducts live session on various social media platforms on 2nd Tuesday of every month apart from special live sessions.

A live session on Facebook, YouTube and Instagram about **Credit of Interest on EPF Accumulations Related Issues** was conducted on 14th January 2025.

A special live Session about **Centralised Pension Payments System** was conducted on 21st January 2025.



A live session on Facebook, YouTube and Instagram on **Simplification of Joint Declaration, EPF Transfer, and Delinking of MIDs** was conducted on 11th February 2025.

A live session on Facebook, YouTube & Instagram about **UAN activation and Aadhaar seeding in UAN & bank account** was conducted on 11th March, 2025.

Educational Content

1. Centralized Pension Payment System (CPPS)

The Union Minister of Labour and Employment and Chairperson of Central Board of Trustees, EPF has approved the proposal for a Centralized Pension Payment System (CPPS) for Employees' Pension Scheme, 1995.

The CPPS marks a major shift by establishing national-level centralized system, enabling pension disbursement through any bank any branch across India.

The CPPS would also ensure disbursement of pension throughout India without any need for transfer of Pension Payment Orders (PPO) from one office to another even when the pensioner moves from one location to another or changes his bank or branch. This would be a great relief to pensioners who move to their hometown after retirement.

To learn more about the CPPS System,visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bHqpQbrGgco

Scan this QR Code to watch the video

2. Bank Account Seeding with UAN

Bank account seeding with UAN (Universal Account Number) is an important process that ensures the smooth and efficient management of your Employees' Provident Fund (EPF) contributions and related transactions. When bank account is linked to UAN, the EPF balance is directly credited to member's account, ensuring quick and hassle-free settlements.

To learn more about how to seed your bank account with UAN, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=yuKJLbziu14

Scan this QR Code to watch the video

3. EPF Profile Correction Simplified

If you're an EPF member and want to update your details like name, date of birth, marital status, etc. You can now make most changes online without EPFO approval and discover what to

do if your employer is unavailable or if your UAN was generated before October 1, 2017.

To learn more about how to update your personal details, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ip1z-YK3m0Y

Scan this QR Code to watch the video

4. Process to Delink Incorrect EPF Member ID from Your UAN

To empower the members to delink any erroneous member-ID in their UAN which had been linked without their knowledge, the members are provided with a facility to de-link such wrongly linked MID's from their UAN.

To learn more about how to de-link incorrect member-ID, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oqaTZovs4UQ

Scan this QR Code to watch the video:

5. EPF Account Transfer Simplified

EPFO introduced a new simplified system to facilitate online submission of transfer claims by members with the objective to make the transfer process transparent, efficient and comfortable for the employees. EPF members with fully compliant e-KYC EPF accounts can now file their online transfer claims directly with EPFO without requiring approval of their employer.

To learn more about how to transfer EPF Account with ease, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VTnvDmFIZ7k

Scan this QR Code to watch the video:

6. DSC for EPF Services

Digital Signature Certification (DSC) is mandatory for employers to perform tasks like KYC updates, transfer claims, filing Form 5A, and modifying establishment details. The EPFO

portal has a DSC registration process that entails installing the DSC signer software, entering information, creating PDFs, and sending in documents for approval.

To learn more about the complete process of registering and using a Digital Signature Certificate (DSC) for EPFO services, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tVbPtPyqVtk

Scan this QR Code to watch the video:

7. Things to Remember While Joining First Job

There are a few things that people must know about EPF (Employee Provident Fund) when starting their first job. Many young employees make mistakes due to lack of information, which can later lead to complications. It is important your EPF is set up correctly for a secure future.

To learn more about the things you should remember while joining your first job, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=F36lS7Xnz2s

Scan this QR Code to watch the video:

8. New Provision under EDLI Scheme

The EDLI scheme offers a valuable insurance benefit to EPF members and their families in case of death. With the new provisions, the scheme has become more beneficial for members. There have been changes in the Employees' Deposit Linked Insurance (EDLI) Scheme, 1976, as approved by the EPFO's Central Board of Trustees in EDLI Scheme.

To learn more about the new provisions under EDLI Scheme, visit this link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KczMy2Hlg3o

Scan this QR Code to watch the video:

EPFO in News January-March 2025

About 22,000 EPFO member got higher pension: Minister

The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) issued 21,885 pension payment orders and asked 1.65 lakh eligible members to deposit additional amount for higher pension, Parliament was informed on Monday. A total of 17,48,768 applications were submitted for higher pension on making higher contribution under Employees' Pension Scheme, Minister of State Labour and Employment Shobha Karandlaje said in a written reply to Lok Sabha. PTI

EPFO simplifies PF account transfer process

ENS ECONOMIC BUREAU @ New Delhi

THE Employee Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) has simplified the process for transfer of PF account on change of jobs wherein the requirement to route online transfer claims through either the previous or current employer has been removed in majority of cases.

According to the EPFO, the introduction of the revised process would result in 94% of the total claims to be directly forwarded to EPFO without requiring the employer's intervention. From April 1, 2024 till date, around 1.30 crore transfer claims have been received by EPFO in the online mode, out of which, about 45 lakh claims are auto-generated transfer claims.

EPFO 3.0 rollout by June: Labour Minister

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya said here on Thursday that the Employees Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) will launch its new software system EPFO 3.0 by June this year. He told presspersons that the new system will be equivalent to the banking systems in the country and the website will be more user friendly.

The Minister said the EPFO will also provide ATM cards to its subscribers after rolling out EPFO 3.0. The first phase of upgrading the website and systems will be completed by the end of January 2025, he added.

Countering the Opposition's charge of growing unemployment in the country, Mr. Mandaviya claimed that the employment has increased under NDA government when compared to UPA government. He claimed that unemployment rate dropped from 6% in 2017-18 to 3.2% in 2023-24.

EPFO settled over 50.8 mn claims in FY25: Mandaviya

The Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) has processed over 50.8 million claims amounting to ₹2.1 trillion, surpassing the 44.5 million claims worth ₹1.9 trillion settled in the previous financial year 2023-24. Also, auto claim settlements doubled to 18.7 million from 8.92 million claims settled in the previous financial year. "We have implemented key measures, including an increase in the ceiling and categories of auto-settled claims, simplified member profile changes, streamlined PF transfers, and improved KYC compliance ratios. These reforms have significantly improved the efficiency of EPFO," said Mandaviya. BS REPORTER

EPFO set to introduce self-attestation facility

Move to do away with the need for nod of employers' to complete KYC

SHIVA RAJORA
New Delhi, 9 January

In a major relief for its 80 million active members, the Employees Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO) is set to introduce a self-attestation facility starting in June that will do away with the need for approval from employers to complete the Know Your Customer (KYC) process.

KYC is a one-time process that helps in verifying the identity of subscribers by linking their universal account number (UAN) with KYC details. Currently, an employer must approve the details of its employees for the KYC process to be completed.

"Providing this facility will help the members complete the process with much ease, as a lot of time is currently wasted in getting approval from employers. Many times, if a firm has closed, the member cannot get the approval. The new facility will do away with all such paperwork and will reduce the rejection of claims as well," the official said.

Apart from this customer-friendly feature to be launched under EPFO 3.0, the social security organisation is also transforming its information technology (IT) infrastructure to manage the added burden of new subscribers that will join the organisation following the implementation of three employment-linked incentive (ELI) schemes.

"One of the features of EPFO 3.0 will be the thrust on scalability. The improved IT infrastructure will help the organisation to offer improved services to its members. As and when new members join the social security net, and we expect the active members to reach 100 million, it will be of great help," he said.

In addition to this, under EPFO 3.0, the retirement fund body is also considering introducing a facility in partnership with various banks that will allow users to withdraw their money, up to a certain extent, without the need to file claims.

Union Labour Minister Mansukh Mandaviya last month told Parliament that EPFO was working to build a robust platform that will enable users to draw their money without any hassles.

"We are working to create a redressal system akin to the banking system. By March, we will be able to launch EPFO 3.0 through which we will be able to solve almost all the user queries," he added.

THE REVAMP

- The facility to provide relief to nearly 80 million active members
- It will help members to complete the process with ease as there will be:
  - Less paperwork and less rejection of claims
  - IT infra transformation to manage the added burden of new subscribers
- Currently, an employer has to approve the details of its employees for the KYC process to be completed
- Retirement fund body plans to introduce facility with various banks that will allow users to withdraw their money up to a certain extent

Our Presence on Social Media

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